TOPIC 1 · UNDERSTANDING THE IMPACT OF CYBER HARM

8 minutes · emotional reactions · why victims stay silent · secondary victimisation · myths about victims

What is it?

Cyber-crime is often treated as “just money” or “just online”. For victims it can feel like a burglary of the mind: someone they trusted turned out to be a criminal, private images may be seen by others, and family savings may be gone. Many victims blame themselves and hide what happened.

Secondary victimisation is harm caused by the reaction of others — family, police, bank staff or helpers — through blame, disbelief or insensitive questions. A First Responder's first job is to make sure it does not happen at their desk.



Figure 7.3 · How cyber harm feels to the victim

Myth	Fact
“Only foolish or greedy people get scammed.”	Scams are designed by professionals to exploit normal human trust, fear and kindness; educated people are frequent victims
“If she had not shared photos, this would not happen.”	Many images are stolen or AI-morphed; responsibility lies with the person who threatens or shares
“Men are not harassed online.”	Anyone can be targeted; boys and men often find it harder to ask for help
“Old people should not use smartphones.”	Senior citizens have every right to digital services; they need support, not exclusion

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TOPIC 2 · PSYCHOLOGICAL FIRST AID: LOOK, LISTEN, LINK

12 minutes · the WHO model · active listening · words to use and avoid · what PFA is not

What is it?

Psychological first aid (PFA) is humane, supportive and practical help for people in distress. It is not counselling or therapy, and it never forces people to talk about what happened. Its three action principles are **Look** (for safety, urgent needs and severe reactions), **Listen** (to needs and concerns, and help people feel calm) and **Link** (to practical help, information, loved ones and services).



Figure 7.4 · Psychological first aid: Look, Listen, Link

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What to say — and what to avoid

Words can heal or harm

Moment	Helpful words	Avoid
Opening	"Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing coming here."	"Why did you...?"
Blame	"This was done to you. These criminals fool doctors, engineers and police officers too."	"You should have known better."
Feelings	"It makes sense that you feel scared. Let's take it one step at a time."	"Calm down." "It's not a big deal."
Hope	"Here is what we can do right now."	"Don't worry, you'll get it all back."
Choice	"Would you like me to stay while you call the bank?"	Taking over without asking

Figure 7.5 · What to say — and what to avoid

Active listening skill	What it looks like
Attending	Face the person; put your phone away; nod; allow silence
Reflecting feelings	"It sounds like you feel embarrassed and worried about your family."
Summarising	"So the call came at 10, you paid twice, and now he wants more. Is that right?"
Open questions	"What happened next?" rather than "Did you give him the OTP?" in an accusing tone
Respecting pace	Let the person stop; return to practical steps when they are ready

Ask yourself

- Did I let the person speak before I started fixing things?
- Did any of my words sound like blame?
- Did I offer choices rather than take over?

Stop	Save	Report
If the person is overwhelmed, pause the technical steps and focus on calm and safety.	Note feelings and needs only as far as relevant, with consent.	Link to practical help and services; agree the next contact.

Remember

Look, listen, link. Practical help is psychological help.

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TOPIC 3 · RECOGNISING RISK: DISTRESS, SELF-HARM AND SAFEGUARDING

10 minutes · warning signs · asking directly · immediate actions · children and vulnerable adults

What is it?

Sextortion, large financial loss and online abuse can push people into crisis. A First Responder must notice the warning signs and act at once. Safety overrides every other part of the case — evidence, forms and reports can wait.

Recognising risk and acting at once

Safety overrides every other task in the case

NOW	Talks of suicide or self-harm; has a plan or means; immediate danger from another person	**Stay with them; 112; Tele-MANAS 14416; trusted person; mentor**	Immediately
URGENT	Child at risk of sexual exploitation or meeting an offender; stalker knows location	**Police / 112; 1098; guardian (unless the guardian is the risk)**	Immediately
WATCH	Severe distress, not eating or sleeping, hopelessness, isolation	**Ask directly about safety; link to Tele-MANAS; agree a check-in**	Same day
SUPPORT	Upset but coping; has people around	**PFA; practical next steps; information**	During the case

Asking directly about suicide does not put the idea in someone's head; it opens the door to help

Figure 7.6 · Recognising risk and acting at once

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If a person talks about suicide or self-harm	Do	Do not
Ask	"Are you thinking about ending your life?" — clearly and calmly	Avoid the question or hint around it
Stay	Stay with them or on the line; remove immediate means if safe	Leave them alone, even briefly
Connect	112 if in immediate danger; Tele-MANAS 14416; a trusted person; inform the mentor	Promise to keep it secret
Follow up	Agree when you will check in; record actions	Assume it has passed because they seem calmer

Child safeguarding

If a child may be at risk of sexual abuse or exploitation — including online grooming or a planned meeting with an adult — inform the police or Special Juvenile Police Unit and Childline 1098 at once. Reporting is a legal duty under POCSO s.19. Do not question the child repeatedly; let trained officers do that. Involve a parent or guardian unless they may be the source of harm.

Remember

Ask directly about safety. Stay. Connect. Never keep a risk to life secret.

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TOPIC 4 · ADAPTING COMMUNICATION TO THE PERSON

10 minutes · trauma-informed principles · senior citizens · children · disability · language and literacy · angry citizens

What is it?

Trauma-informed support means assuming that the person may be affected by trauma and avoiding anything that re-traumatises them. Five principles guide every conversation. Then the message is adapted to the listener — the same next step may need different words, pace and format.



Figure 7.7 · Five principles of trauma-informed support

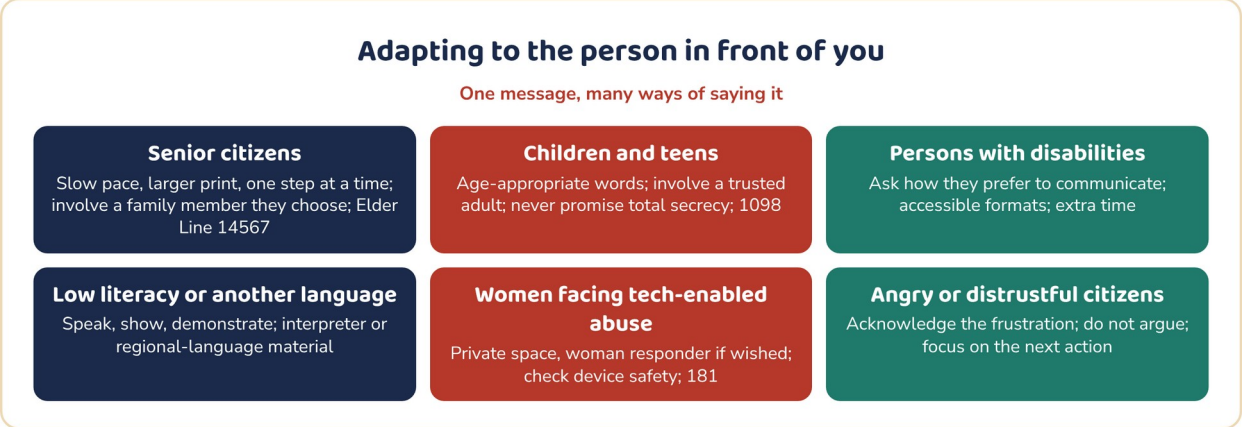


Figure 7.8 · Adapting to the person in front of you

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Same message	For a senior citizen	For a 15-year-old	For a busy shopkeeper
Report the fraud to 1930 now	“Let us call 1930 together now. I will dial; you speak. I will write the numbers on this card.”	“This is not your fault. Let's tell your mum and call 1930 together — the sooner, the better.”	“Two minutes: call 1930 now with the UTR from your sound-box app; I will help you finish the complaint after.”

Checking understanding

Instead of “Do you understand?”, ask the person to say back the next step: “Just so I know I explained it well, what will you do when you get home?” This is called **teach-back**, and it is the same method used in V1 assessments.

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TOPIC 5 · SUPPORTING SPECIFIC HARMS AND REFERRAL

12 minutes · financial loss · image abuse · stalking and tech-enabled abuse · children · harassment · the referral directory

What is it?

Each type of harm brings its own fears and needs. A First Responder combines the technical first response from Modules 2–6 with the emotional support of this module, and links the person to services that can do more than the Responder can.

Support and referral by type of harm

Practical help is psychological help

Harm	What the person most needs	Refer to
Financial loss	Fast action, clear steps, no blame, help telling family	1930, bank, NCRP; legal aid 15100 if needed
Sextortion or image abuse	"Not your fault", safety check, stop the spread	StopNCII / Take It Down, platform, NCRP, 181, police
Cyberstalking or tech-enabled abuse	Safety planning, device check, trusted people	Police, 181, One Stop Centre (Sakhi), NCRP
Child harmed online	Calm adult, protection, no repeated questioning	1098, police / SJPU, NCRP child section
Loan-app or online harassment	Reassurance that threats are a crime; contacts warned	NCRP, police, app store report
Severe distress at any time	Someone to stay; professional support	Tele-MANAS 14416; 112 if in danger

Figure 7.9 · Support and referral by type of harm

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Service	Contact	For
Emergency Response Support System	112	Any emergency, danger to life
National cyber-crime helpline	1930 · cybercrime.gov.in	Financial fraud; all cyber-crime complaints
Childline	1098	Children in need of care and protection
Women Helpline	181	Women facing violence, including online
Tele-MANAS (mental health)	14416	Free, confidential mental health support, 24×7, many languages
Elder Line	14567	Senior citizens: information, guidance, emotional support
NALSA legal aid	15100	Free legal services for eligible persons
One Stop Centres (Sakhi)	Through 181 or district administration	Integrated support for women affected by violence

Tech-enabled abuse: a careful approach

When a partner or family member monitors or controls someone through their phone (stalkerware, location sharing, account access), removing it suddenly may alert the abuser and increase danger. First talk about safety, use a safe device for help-seeking, and refer to police, 181 or a One Stop Centre for a safety plan before changing settings.

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TOPIC 6 · CONFIDENTIALITY, CLOSURE AND SELF-CARE

8 minutes · consent and privacy · shared spaces · closing a case · vicarious trauma · looking after yourself

What is it?

A citizen's story, identity and evidence belong to them. Share only what an agency needs, only with consent (except where the law requires reporting, such as child sexual abuse), and never on social media or group chats. A case is closed well when the person knows what happens next and how to reach help.

Confidentiality rule	In practice
Consent	Ask before recording or sharing; explain who will see the information
Minimum data	Collect only what is needed; no secrets; no copies of intimate material
Private space	Move away from queues and family members unless the person wants them present
Limits of confidentiality	Explain early: risk to life and child abuse must be reported
Secure records	Case files in the agreed system; no names on shared dashboards

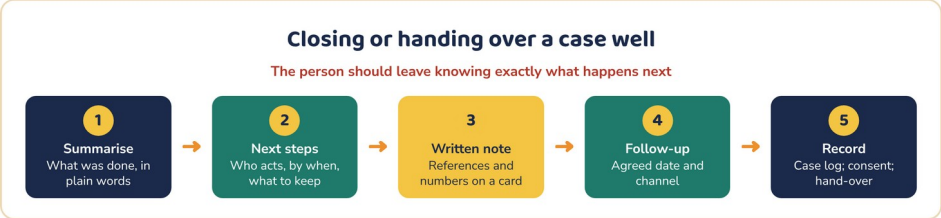


Figure 7.10 · Closing or handing over a case well



Figure 7.11 · Looking after yourself

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM MODULE 7

Takeaway	In one line
Never blame	The criminal is responsible; say so
Look · Listen · Link	Calm, practical, choice-giving help
Safety first	Ask directly, stay, connect — risk overrides everything
Adapt and check	Right words for the person; teach-back to confirm
Refer, protect, recover	Link to services; keep confidentiality; look after yourself

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